

SpeakEasy - Qualcomm Team #2

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Our capstone project focused on developing a solution that helps users improve their public speaking skills through structured feedback and performance insights. The goal was to create an accessible and supportive tool that allows users to build confidence, refine delivery techniques and overcome common challenges that people face when it comes to public speaking like nervousness, pacing issues and a lack of clarity. By combining technology with principles of communication and self-improvement, our project aimed to make public speaking practice more engaging, less intimidating and more effective.

Throughout the project we implemented scrum and kanban as a team this was done by implementing a hybrid approach that helped manage our workflow effectively. At the beginning of our project, as a group we established a shared task board using Jira. This Jira board was where we organized all tasks into specific columns like the Backlog, In Progress, In Review and Done. This organized structure allowed us to visualize the status of our work and track the progress of our project in real time. We followed a Scrum inspired practice by holding regular sprint planning meetings, typically on a weekly basis where we discussed upcoming deliverables, assigned responsibilities, and prioritized tasks based on urgency and impact. Each sprint had clearly defined goals, which helped align the team on what tasks needed to be completed within a specific time frame. In addition, we also had brief check-ins during the week to discuss progress, roadblocks and any adjustments if needed. At the same time, we also adopted Kanban principles. These principles allowed tasks to flow continuously rather than strictly limiting work to a fixed boundary. This flexibility was especially useful when unexpected issues or changes in project scopes came up as it enables us to adapt without restructuring the sprint plan and deviating drastically from the current plan. One of the most effective aspects of our approach was the visual task board, which created transparency and accountability among

everyone on the team. Everyone had a clear understanding of who was responsible for certain tasks and which stage each task was in. This significantly reduced confusion and any duplication of tasks and effort. Our regular sprint planning sessions also worked well because they encouraged open communication and collaboration. These meetings allowed us to break down complex tasks into smaller manageable tasks and align our expectations clearly, which improved efficiency and reduced any last-minute stress. Scrum's structure helped us stay organized and goal-oriented, while Kanban's flexibility allowed us to adapt to real-time needs without feeling overwhelmed and constrained by rigid timelines and structures.

Despite these strengths, there were some areas where our implementation was not as effective. At times, task estimation was overly optimistic, which led to some deadlines being missed or rushed towards the end of a sprint. Another challenge that we faced was communication during particularly busy periods. While we had scheduled meetings, we did not always use asynchronous communication as effectively as we could have, leading to minor delays when issues could have been addressed sooner.

If we were to continue working on this project, we would focus on refining our agile workflow by improving task estimation and enforcing clearer sprint boundaries. We would implement more realistic timelines by breaking tasks down further and incorporating buffer time for unexpected tasks and unexpected issues along the way. We would also introduce more frequent but shorter check-ins, such as daily standups, to improve communication and catch roadblocks that we face earlier. Finally we would commit more consistently to retrospective meetings at the end of each sprint. These sessions would allow us to reflect on our progress, performance, identify recurring issues and continuously improve our workflow to refine both productivity and team collaboration.